

November 20, 2025

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Dear editor,

I wish to resubmit a manuscript titled *A model of macroalgal decomposition* for consideration as a research article in *Ecological Modelling*. I had previously submitted this manuscript as ECOMOD-25-2094 whereupon it was desk rejected by error. Then the manuscript was transferred to a different journal by the Elsevier manuscript transfer service. Upon enquiry I was told of the rejection error and was encouraged to resubmit to *Ecological Modelling*. I contacted the other journal to withdraw the transferred submission and resubmitted (ECOMOD-25-2191). Unfortunately, the withdrawal from the other journal did not happen in time, causing my resubmission to be flagged as plagiarism in your system. I have now made sure the withdrawal is complete. I hope that you can send my manuscript to peer-review straight away as promised since the error has cost quite some time. Please see the attached email exchange for details. All data and code are available in my open-access repository at github.com/lukaseamus/limbodeco and I encourage you to pass these on to the reviewers.

Sincerely,
Luka Seamus Wright

Dear Dr. Wright,

Thank you for your email and for following my previous suggestions regarding your manuscript submission. I understand the challenges you are facing with the withdrawal process from ECOCOM and the recent issues encountered with ECOMOD.

Please be informed that once you still have active submission to another Journal with same article title it will be tagged as plagiarism. As I mentioned in my previous email, *"You may either wait for the decision of your paper ECOCOM-D-25-00179 or you may request to withdraw this paper before resubmitting your paper to Ecological Modelling Journal to avoid duplication."*

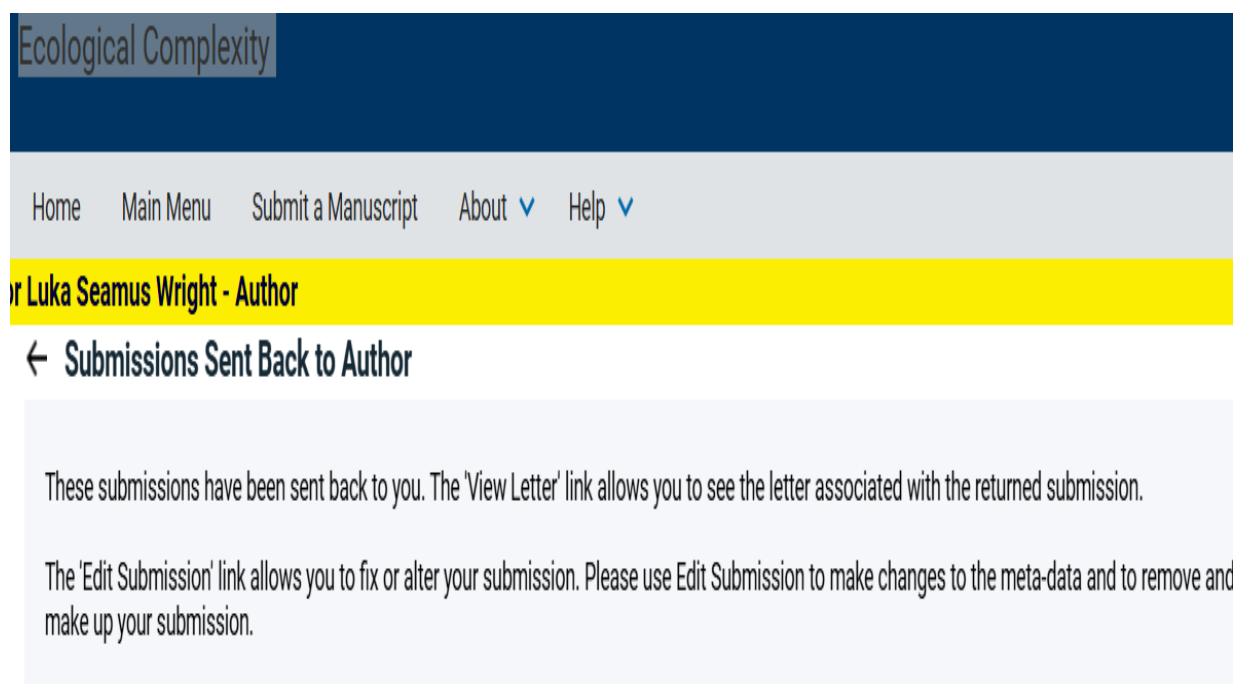
However, I understand that you want to withdraw your paper ECOCOM-D-25-00179 from Ecological Complexity Journal.

Please be advised that sent back has been initiated for the aforesaid paper so that you have the option to remove the submission in the system.

To access the sent back submission, log onto Elsevier Editorial System as an Author: <https://www.editorialmanager.com/ecocom/default2.aspx>

1. Go to the menu item "Submissions Sent Back to Author".
2. Click "Remove Submission".

Please see attached screenshot below for your reference.



The 'Remove Submission' link removes your submission from the system. Please use this ONLY if you would like to permanently remove this submission.

Page: 1 of 1 (1 total submissions)

Action	Manuscript Number	Title	Transferred From	Date Submission Began	Status Date	Current Status
View Submission View Letter Edit Submission Approve Submission Remove Submission View Reference Checking Results Send E-mail		A model of macroalgal decomposition	Elsevier	Nov 12, 2025	Nov 19, 2025	Sent Back to Author

Once done, you may resubmit your paper in Ecological Modelling Journal. I recommend providing them with a brief explanation of the circumstances surrounding the submission to your Cover letter. You may also indicate there that you have done removing it from ECOCOM and also the editor in ECOMOD is allowing you to resubmit it.

If you have further concerns, do let me know.

Kind regards,

Emilyn Kilapkilap
Researcher Support Agent
ELSEVIER

Visit the [Author Guide to Editorial Manager](#) for a guided walkthrough of author key tasks, such as manuscript submission process and how to track your manuscript.

Visit the [Reviewer Guide to Editorial Manager](#) for a guided walkthrough of reviewer key tasks.

From: Luka Wright

Date: Wednesday, November 19, 2025 12:53 PM GMT

Thanks for getting back to me Emilyn,

I have done what you suggested and put in a request for more information

with ECOCOM with the aim of withdrawing my submission. I cannot see a direct way to withdraw through the submission site. There is no button labelled "withdraw" in the actions menu.

I have also followed your advice and resubmitted the manuscript to ECOMOD. It has the manuscript number ECOMOD-25-2191. However, I immediately received a reply from the ECOMOD editor saying the manuscript got flagged for plagiarism and they would reject it again. I am sure the work is completely original. Could this be an error due to the fact that the manuscript was transferred to ECOCOM and they have not yet withdrawn it from their system?

Could you please help me communicate this with the editors at ECOMOD and ensure my manuscript finally gets to peer review with them and withdrawn from ECOCOM?

Kind regards,
Luka

From: Emilyn Kilapkilap

Date: Tuesday, November 18, 2025 11:32 PM GMT

Dear Dr. Wright.

Thank you for your email regarding the status of your manuscript. I understand your concerns about ensuring that your paper is properly considered for peer review, especially after its recent transfer to ECOCOM.

I have checked the status of your paper in Ecological Complexity Journal, with manuscript ECOCOM-D-25-00179. I can confirm that, at present, your submission is undergoing pre-assignment technical checks. This is to ensure that your submission meets the journal submission requirements, and you will be contacted shortly if any corrections are required.

Once approved, your paper will be assigned to an editor for handling, and you will receive a confirmation email containing an editorial reference.

Guidance on the status of your paper is also available at [When can I expect a decision from the Editor?](#)

However, if you would like to resubmit your paper to Ecological Modelling. You may either wait for the decision of your paper ECOCOM-D-25-00179 or you may request to withdraw this paper before resubmitting your paper to Ecological Modelling Journal to avoid duplication.

Additionally, I understand that you want to know if this your paper is properly considered for peer review to Ecological Modelling Journal. Please be informed that when you submitted your paper and assigned to the editor for an initial assessment. Following this, the editor will either decide or send your paper to potential reviewers. Based on the response of the editor in previous email you are welcome to resubmit your paper as it was *rejected by errors*.

Thank you for your patience and understanding. If you need any further assistance, please let me know and I would be happy to help you further.

Kind regards,

Emilyn Kilapkilap
Researcher Support Agent
ELSEVIER

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Visit the [Reviewer Guide to Editorial Manager](#) for a guided walkthrough of reviewer key tasks.

From: Luka Wright

Date: Sunday, November 16, 2025 10:46 PM GMT

Thank you Emilyn,

I used the ELSEVIER manuscript transfer service after rejection by ECOMOD so the manuscript is currently with ECOCOM rather than ECOMOD. I have not heard back from the editors at ECOCOM. I would like that sorted before resubmitting to ECOMOD. Could you please confirm that ECOMOD is indeed willing to send my paper to peer review? I do not want to be desk rejected again, especially since ECOCOM may be willing to send my paper to peer review. ECOMOD of course is my preference as I submitted there first.

Kind regards,
Luka

From: Emilyn Kilapkilap

Date: Sunday, November 16, 2025 12:07 AM GMT

Dear Dr. Wright,

This is a follow-up email.

I would like to inform you that the editor responded regarding the decision for manuscript, ECOMOD-25-2094.

Please see the editor's response below for your reference.

"I just double checked the manuscript, and, indeed, it fits the aims and scope. It must be rejected by errors. Please encourage the author to resubmit it. Thank you."

If there is anything further that I can assist you with, please do not hesitate to contact me. I will be happy to assist you.

Kind regards,

Emilyn Kilapkilap
Researcher Support Agent
ELSEVIER

Visit the [Author Guide to Editorial Manager](#) for a guided walkthrough of author key tasks, such as manuscript submission process and how to track your manuscript.

Visit the [Reviewer Guide to Editorial Manager](#) for a guided walkthrough of reviewer key tasks.

From: Emilyn Kilapkilap

Date: Saturday, November 15, 2025 01:05 AM GMT

Dear Dr. Wright,

Thank you for your email. I apologize for the delayed response.

I completely understand that you are contacting us regarding the decision for manuscript, ECOMOD-25-2094.

Please be advised that I've forwarded your concern to the Editor who can further assist you regarding this matter.

Rest assured that you'll be contacted as soon as we hear back from the editor.

I look forward to your continued patience and understanding of this matter.

If there is anything further that I can assist you with, please do not hesitate to contact me. I will be happy to assist you.

Kind regards,

Emilyn Kilapkilap

Researcher Support Agent

ELSEVIER

Visit the [Author Guide to Editorial Manager](#) for a guided walkthrough of author key tasks, such as manuscript submission process and how to track your manuscript.

Visit the [Reviewer Guide to Editorial Manager](#) for a guided walkthrough of reviewer key tasks.

From: Administrator

Date: Tuesday, November 11, 2025 10:29 PM GMT

Hello!

Thank you for contacting Elsevier Researcher Support.

To help us jump right into the solution, please ensure you have provided as much information as possible.

While you wait, you can take a look at our [Journal Article Publishing Support Center](#) where you can review FAQs and 'how to' videos.

To help ensure a fast response, please do not change the subject line of this email when replying. For any future correspondence, remember to quote your unique reference number provided in the subject line.

Regards,

Elsevier Researcher Support

From: Luka Wright

Date: Tuesday, November 11, 2025 10:29 PM GMT

Dear Dr Wang,

Thank you for your email. Would you please be able to provide a rationale for your decision? As mentioned in my letter, my manuscript fits the scope of Ecological Modelling well, so that cannot be the reason. I would appreciate feedback so I can improve my manuscript.

Kind regards,
Luka

On 12. Nov 2025, at 00:29, Ecological Modelling
<em@editorialmanager.com> wrote:

Manuscript Number: **ECOMOD-25-2094**

A model of macroalgal decomposition

Dear Mr Wright,

Thank you for submitting your manuscript to Ecological Modelling. After careful evaluation, I regret to inform you that your manuscript does not fit within the scope of the journal, and I must therefore reject it.

I hope you are successful in finding an alternative publication for your work. For alternative journals that may be more suitable for your manuscript, please refer to our

[Journal Finder](#)

.

We appreciate you submitting your manuscript to Ecological Modelling and thank you for giving us the opportunity to consider your work.

Kind Regards,

Hsiao-Hsuan Wang, Ph.D.
Editor-in-Chief
Ecological Modelling

Editor comments:

While your results are of potential interest, the topic of your manuscript falls outside of the scope of this journal. For an overview of the Aims & Scope, please have a look at the journals' homepage. We hope you will consider the journal for publication of future studies within the scope. Please consider using this tool (<https://journalfinder.elsevier.com/>) to identify a suitable journal for your work.

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(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=o5l8thD9XtE>). Please remember that you can contact Elsevier's Researcher Support team (<https://service.elsevier.com/app/home/supporthub/publishing/>) at any time if you have questions about your manuscript, and you can log into Editorial Manager to check the status of your manuscript

(https://service.elsevier.com/app/answers/detail/a_id/29155/c/10530/supporthub/publishing/kw/status/).

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